

# AI for Excel Demo Day

Your one-page takeaway — the lagniappe.

STRINGFEST ANALYTICS

[stringfestanalytics.com](https://stringfestanalytics.com)

## PROMPT RECIPE · G · C · S · E

*Adapted from Microsoft's "Art and science of prompting."*

**G**

### Goal

What response do you want?

**C**

### Context

Why do you need it, and who is involved?

**S**

### Source

Which file, range, or sheet should it look at?

**E**

### Expectations

Format, length, tone, what to avoid.

## GOOD → GREAT · ON TODAY'S DATA

**GOOD** *"Find total sales by channel."*

Vague. "Sales" doesn't exist. "Channel" is a code. No file context. No format.

**GREAT** *"From the wholesale-customers table, treat Channel 1 as HoReCa and 2 as Retail. Compute total annual spend per customer as the sum of Fresh, Milk, Grocery, Frozen, Detergents\_Paper, and Delicassen. Return the sum of total spend grouped by Channel as a two-row table with whole-dollar values."*

### WHY IT WORKS

**Source:** names the table explicitly

**Context:** translates the channel codes

**Goal:** defines what 'total sales' actually means

**Expectations:** specifies the output shape and units

## PROBABILISTIC vs DETERMINISTIC

### Probabilistic

*Best guess from a model*

- Analyze Data, Copilot, ChatGPT, Claude
- Fast, flexible, conversational
- Can be confidently wrong
- Different answer every time

### Deterministic

*Same steps, same result*

- Power Query, formulas, PivotTables, VBA
- Auditable and repeatable
- Boring — in the best way
- Same answer every refresh

Use the probabilistic tool to plan. Use the deterministic tool to ship.

## Next: nail the foundation

### Modern Data Analytics in Excel

*Power Query · Power Pivot · Dynamic Arrays*

The deterministic half of the equation — the part the AI can't do for you.

Learn more → [stringfestanalytics.com/maxl](https://stringfestanalytics.com/maxl)

